

The FRAME WORK

The infrastructure sector has perhaps the least amount of data available. This must change, given that it is responsible for many of India's shining showpieces of modernity.

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It's the one success that is easy to see. It can be spotted on the roads, the Railways, ports and power, in steel factories and new age airports. The foundation of 21st century India lies in companies like Larsen & Toubro with over 37,000 employees and an annual turnover of Rs 34,000 crore, that has to its credit projects like the world's longest LPG pipeline, or Indus Telecom, a one-lakh tower company, the result of a partnership between three independent telecom operators. It also lies in Hyderabad's sleek Rajiv Gandhi International Airport with its 20,000 sq m of glass conceived by the man behind the Oslo airport, in BEST that transports 45 lakh Mumbaikars in 4,300 buses every day, in BHEL that generates 73 per cent of the total power in India, in ONGC, the world's largest oil and gas company, and in Tata Steel that produces 6.8 million tonnes of steel. The success is also in experiments like JUSCO, a private-public partnership providing urban services in Jamshedpur, Mysore and Kolkata and HCC, that has built the 4.7-km long Bandra-Worli Sealink and the Farakka Barrage in West Bengal.

Yet, infrastructure, one of India's key sectors, remains shrouded in mystery. Even its definition is amorphous.

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